

Restoration Counseling

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Disclosure Statement and Informed Consent

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

Thank you for choosing me as your counselor! This document is designed to provide information about the therapeutic process, my training and approach, as well as to ensure that you understand the professional relationship of counselor and client. You have the right to inquire about my professional credentials and experience, so feel free to ask questions at any point.

I am a certified Licensed Professional Counselor and a National Certified Counselor with a master's degree in Clinical Mental Health Counseling from Sam Houston State University (2014) and a bachelor's degree in Psychology (2011) from Sam Houston State University.

The majority of my practice consists of working with individuals, families, and couples through the process of Cognitive Behavioral Therapy, Dialectical Behavioral Therapy, EMDR, Brainspotting, and/or Christian-based counseling. I believe that clients have the ability to choose how to resolve their own problems and can make their own decisions with my assistance as a facilitator. Ultimately, success in therapy depends to some degree on the desire for change and one's willingness to be honest with his or herself and with me. As your counselor, I hope to facilitate greater self-awareness through your life experiences that lead to increased confidence, self-esteem, independence, mental health, and the capacity to effectively navigate the complex challenges of life.

LIMITS OF TREATMENT AND CODE OF ETHICS- ITEM 1

Please take note that as your counselor, I am not able to prescribe medications to clients.

Some clients need only a few counseling sessions to achieve the goals we set out to accomplish, while others may require more counseling. As a client, you maintain control of yourself, and you may end our counseling relationship at any point. If you are dissatisfied with my work, or it is concluded that I might not be the most qualified counselor available to effectively address your

goals, I will gladly provide you with community referrals. It is recommended that any conflicts or concerns that arise within the counselor/client relationship be resolved within session. If we are unable to resolve such conflicts, you have the right to contact the Texas Behavioral Health Executive Council. If you wish to file a consumer complaint to the board, you may visit www.bhec.texas.gov/discipline-and-complaints or call 1-800-821-3205.

While our sessions might be very intimate psychologically, it is important for you to understand that we have a professional relationship rather than a social relationship. Our contacts, other than chance meetings, will be limited to appointments you arrange with me. I will not attend social gatherings, interact with you on social media, accept gifts from you, or relate to you in any other way than in the professional context of our counseling sessions. You will be best served if our relationship remains strictly professional and our sessions concentrate exclusively on your concerns. While you might learn much about me as we work together, it is important for you to remember that you are experiencing my professional role.

CONFIDENTIALITY- ITEM 2

As your counselor, I strive to create an environment based on trust and safety. All information disclosed within the session will not be revealed to anyone without your permission. If I see you in public, I will protect your confidentiality by not acknowledging or approaching you (unless directed otherwise by the client). You are in control of the counseling relationship; therefore, if you choose to approach or acknowledge me in public, that will be left to your discretion. I will not discuss your counseling goals or any therapeutic content in any public place.

- * In the case of child clients, parents (with legal custody) have legal rights to know the content of our counseling sessions. However, it is better for the client's progress if information is only disclosed to parents at the counselor's discretion.
- * In a case of the counselor's leave (e.g., location change, maternity leave, and/or retirement), it is understood that you will not hold the counselor responsible for events that may occur post-discharge or related to such a discharge. At the counselor's leave, it is understood that you will be discharged from treatment services and provided with referrals for further care.
- * In the case that your counselor discerns she is not the best match for your counseling treatment, your counselor reserves the right to terminate counseling sessions and provide you with referrals for further care. It is understood that you will not hold the counselor liable for any actions related to decisions of this nature.
- * **Custodian of Records in the event of your counselor's death and/or unexpected leave:** In the event of your own counselor's death or unexpected leave, your health records will be handled by Donna Wilson, LPC-A (currently supervised by Cheryl Butler, LPC-S). By signing this form, you acknowledge your understanding and agreement of this action. If such an event should occur, you can contact Mosaics of Mercy for continuation of care referrals. Alyssa Meyers and/or anyone connected to Alyssa will not be held liable for your emotional and/or behavioral responses to such an event.

Confidentiality will not be upheld, and disclosure will be made if there is reasonable suspicion that you are in danger of hurting yourself or someone else; I become aware of or suspect abuse, neglect or exploitation of a child, an elder, or an adult with a disability; or if I am ordered by a court of law to disclose information. By signing this document, you are also providing consent for your counselor to disclose information to authorities (e.g., police, CPS, APS) should such a situation arise.

*Please provide an emergency contact name and phone number on your online portal account.

TESTIFYING IN COURT- ITEM 3

Due to the nature of the therapeutic process and the fact that it often involves making a full disclosure about matters which are confidential in nature, it is agreed upon that should there be legal proceedings neither you, nor your attorney, nor anyone else acting on your behalf will call me to testify in court or at any proceeding. Nor will a disclosure of the psychotherapy records be requested for these matters. Should I receive a subpoena by the court, an individual hourly fee of \$150.00 will be applied for the time involved (includes gathering paperwork, drive time, etc.) and charged directly to the client.

WRITTEN CORRESPONDENCE- ITEM 4

Written notice of your appointments (e.g., work excuse, school excuse, superbill information for insurance reimbursement) will be provided upon client request and is free of charge. Please take note that I am not appropriately trained to complete more extensive documentation, such as psychological evaluations, mediation evaluations, divorce decree recommendations, disability paperwork, prescriptions for medications, recommendation/approval for emotional support animals (ESA), or any other medical documentation.

NOTICE OF PRIVACY AND PRACTICES- ITEM 5

Although I do not accept insurance, I would be happy to provide a written or electronic receipt that can be filed to your insurance company for your own personal reimbursement. Under the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1996 (HIPAA), you have certain rights to privacy regarding your protected health information. At your request I will provide you with a copy of the Health Information Privacy and Policy Act (HIPAA). ***Please take note that insurance companies require disclosure of health information to certify the necessity of care.*** This includes but is not limited to a diagnosis or description of the mental condition, the type of service being received, and dates of service. At times files may be audited and treatment plans, progress notes, and summaries will be provided to your insurance company. Any diagnosis made will become a part of your permanent health record.

FEES AND PAYMENTS- ITEM 6

Fee per session is **\$150** in exchange for individual and family counseling services. Sessions are approximately 50 minutes in duration. If an extended session is arranged, an increase in fee will apply, and the client will be charged \$75 for every additional 25-minutes.

It is important to notify your counselor 24 hours in advance if you need to cancel or reschedule your appointment. If notification is less than 24 hours in advance, there will be a **\$75** fee that cannot be filed for reimbursement. ***If you fail to notify your counselor and do not show up for a scheduled appointment, there will be a charge for the full amount (\$150 for individual or family) of a session.*** You agree to pay this amount should such a situation arise. Due to back-to-back appointments, if notification is sent within the hour prior to your scheduled session, this will also count as a no-show appointment and will be charged the full amount for a session.

By signing this form, you understand to pay these fees as each situation arises. Credit card information will be gathered through your portal registration, and by doing so you are providing permission for Restoration Counseling to charge your card for session payments (unless cash or check is preferred), late fees, and no-show fees. The financial information you provide will remain confidential and will be utilized for rendering reimbursement of provider services. Superbill receipts are available upon request.

If late cancellations appear repetitive, please understand that this increases the chances of losing your spot or being referred out. If there is failure to contact your counselor and/or reschedule the appointment within the next week, there is a high possibility that your spot may be filled. In addition, if payments are not fulfilled in a timely manner, please understand that you will be discharged from counselor's care unless discussed otherwise.

GOOD FAITH ESTIMATE- ITEM 7

If you decide not to file for reimbursement through your insurance, I have provided a "good faith estimate" below. Since I have not yet evaluated your difficulties or symptoms, I must at this point estimate your course of treatment based upon the national average for a course of psychotherapy, which is 18 encounters.

The following is a list of expected charges for 50-minute Psychotherapy Services provided by Alyssa Meyers, LPC, NPI Number: 1821531518

90791_ Assessment Cost: \$150.00 (1 session)

90837_ Individual Psychotherapy Cost: \$150.00 (17 sessions)

Current ICD-10 Diagnosis: R69 (diagnosis deferred)

At \$150.00 per session, the estimated cost of treatment would be \$2,700.

This estimate expires one year from the date of intake, but you are entitled to receive an update on this estimate at any time upon request. This is just a rough estimate based on national

averages. The duration of our work together can be longer or shorter depending upon your symptoms, your work between sessions, and your response to treatment.

Unless required by a court order (an extremely rare situation), you are free to discontinue treatment at any time and free to discuss any other modification to treatment modalities, frequency, or duration.

COMMUNICATION- ITEM 8

Communication should be kept professional, and all questions or concerns outside of session are recommended to be by telephone or email during normal business hours. Please take note that texting about therapeutic matters is not an acceptable mode of communication at Restoration Counseling. If emergencies arise and I am unable to answer my phone, it is understood that you should reach out to your support system and/or the emergency numbers listed in Item 10. Communication by telephone for the first 15 minutes is a complimentary service I provide. However, if frequent phone calls occur it is recommended that you bring your concerns into the counseling session by requesting an appointment.

If phone calls exceed 15 minutes, the following fees will apply:

0-15 minutes: Complimentary

25-minute (approx. time) Phone/video session: \$75

50-minute (approx. time) Phone/video session: \$150

It is requested that clients keep cell phones and electronics on silent throughout sessions to avoid distractions. Personal phone calls for emergencies are permitted; however, if cell phone use becomes a frequent distraction in session, I will request that the session end (session fee applies).

TELETHERAPY- ITEM 9

For clients participating in teletherapy, recording and/or taking screenshots of sessions are strictly prohibited (by either party). Sessions must be held in a private environment-- free of distraction and with good internet connection. Although sessions are held in the comfort of your own home, please remain mindful of social norms and appropriate behavior within the counselor-client relationship. For safety reasons, if you are located somewhere other than your home address, please be sure to inform your counselor of your location at the beginning of the appointment. Cancellation policies apply, and your counselor reserves the right to decline the use of teletherapy if it is determined to no longer be appropriate for your treatment.

DUTY OF CARE- ITEM 10

Discharge paperwork will be completed by your counselor and put in your file after two-three consecutive months of non-communication (i.e., no counseling facilitated, no plans for scheduling an appointment). A copy of this paperwork will be shared with you upon request.

Once discharge paperwork has been completed, you will no longer be considered an active client at Restoration Counseling. If you are interested in resuming counseling after this point, you are welcome to contact me to discuss reopening your file and setting up an appointment. However, please take note that I cannot guarantee availability once a discharge has occurred, which may result in you being referred out.

***TREATMENT OF A MINOR- ITEM 11 (adult clients will skip this section and move to section 10)**

Consent for Treatment of a minor (under the age of 18)

As parent or legal guardian of a minor-aged client, you give your consent for your child to be treated by Alyssa Meyers. By signing this form, you understand that certain topics discussed in session may not be disclosed to you if the counselor discerns that keeping information confidential would be most beneficial for your child's mental health progress.

In the event of a divorce, your therapist must have a copy of the Divorce Decree signed by a judge. The decree must state which parent has Managing Conservatory privileges for the minor. At the initial appointment, at least one biological parent must be present. Please provide a copy of the divorce decree at your first counseling appointment. The only exception will be if both biological parents are present for the appointment and have signed the informed consent.

Counseling cannot be provided for children of divorce without a copy of custody documents.

EMERGENCY SERVICES- ITEM 12

If an emergency situation arises after hours you are advised to call 911, a phone number listed below, or proceed to the nearest emergency room or clinic.

Emergency List

Tri-County Psychiatric Emergency Treatment Center: 800-659-6994

National Suicide Prevention Line: 1-800-273-TALK (8255)

Teen Crisis Hotline: Text "START" to 741741

Montgomery County Mental Health Division and Crisis Intervention Team:

936-760-5800 (non-emergency)// 936-539-7828 (mental health warrant assistant)

Cypress Creek Hospital: 281-586-7600

Woodland Springs Hospital: 936-213-5843

IntraCare North Hospital: 281-893-7200

Kingwood Pines Hospital: 281-404-1001

The Harris Center (Houston) Crisis Helpline: 713-970-7000 or

Memorial Hermann Crisis Clinic (Spring Branch): 713-338-MHCC(6422)

Gulf Coast Center Crisis Hotline: 866-729-3848

***By electronically signing below, you are acknowledging that you have read the above paperwork, understand the content in its entirety, and agree to all information described for the duration of your counseling experience. Addenda and/or revisions will be added as necessary.